THE BULLOCK PRESIDENCY

Series Bible — Document 01: Foundation & Locked-In Canon

1. Locked-In Rules (Canon)

- **Present day of the story:** the year 2023. The story begins **Sunday, January 1, 2023**, and moves forward chronologically.
- **Central subject:** the Presidency of **Marc-Anthony Bullock**, from his candidacy announcement through the end of his second term as the **47th President of the United States** — and beyond, because a catastrophic event leads the American people to want him to stay in office past two terms.
- **Candidacy announcement: Thursday, April 20, 2023**. It is 100% unexpected and spur of the moment — not planned by him, his circle, or the press.
- **Format:** screenplay format, heavily character- and dialogue-driven, mixed with political media articles and headlines, social media posts, and internet content (forums, comment sections, trending topics, memes, livestreams).
- **Realism:** grounded in real life. Real people and real 2023 events appear alongside fictional people.
- **Timeline accuracy:** every scene carries a date and time. Every character's age is calculated from their real birthday on that exact date.
- **Tone:** creative, interesting, entertaining, dramatic, realistic, and original.
- **Absolutely nobody is nerfed.** Every ally, rival, journalist, foreign leader, and institution operates at full real-world competence (see Section 6).
- **Fictional characters:** to be created by the author later and added to canon at that point.
- **Output format:** every deliverable for this story is produced as a PDF.

1B. LOCKED: The Looming Event Right Now

As of where the story is now (January 2023), the long-term looming event everyone is talking about is the 2024 presidential election.

- In-world, the 2024 race is the horizon: Will Biden (80) run again? Can Trump (76), who declared Nov 15, 2022, win back the White House? Will DeSantis challenge him? It dominates cable news, social media, dinner tables, and Hollywood fundraisers.
- **Characters know only what people knew in January 2023.** Nobody in the story knows that Marc will run (it's spur of the moment on Apr 20, 2023), that the 28th Amendment is coming, or anything about the war, the 2032 crisis, or third terms.
- Long-range events (the 2027 Taiwan crisis, the successions in China, Russia, North Korea, and Iran, The Blinding in 2032) live only in the bible. On the page they appear only as subtle seeds and B-plots that nobody yet recognizes as significant.
- As the story advances, the looming event moves forward with it: 2024 election, then the first term, then the 2028 re-election, and so on.

2. Serialized vs. Standalone: The Recommended Mix

Recommendation: 80% serialized / 20% standalone.

This is a decade-plus saga in which every choice compounds: a campaign promise in 2023 becomes a legislative fight in 2025 and a crisis talking point in 2028. Continuity is the priority, so the main spine has to be serialized. A pure 100% serial, though, gets airless over a story this long. The 20% standalone share gives you room to breathe and to deepen characters without stalling the larger story.

How the 80% works (serialized)

- The campaign arc, primaries, general election, transition, and each term.
- Long-running rivalries, alliances, scandals, investigations, and legislative battles.
- The slow build toward, and the fallout from, the catastrophic event.
- Personal arcs: family, marriage or relationships, staff loyalty and betrayal, health, and the cost of power.

How the 20% works (standalone)

- "Day in the life" episodes (one 24-hour day told hour by hour).
- A single debate, interview, summit, or crisis contained in one installment.
- Point-of-view episodes from a reporter, a Secret Service agent, an opponent, or an ordinary voter.
- "The Internet Reacts" installments told almost entirely through posts, headlines, and comment threads.
- **Rule:** even standalone installments never break canon. Their events, injuries, quotes, and headlines carry forward.

3. Genres, Subgenres, and Rating

Category	Recommendation	Why it fits
Primary genre	**Political Drama**	The core engine is power, how you win it, and what it costs (*The West Wing*, *House of Cards*, *Succession*).
Co-genre	**Political Thriller**	High-stakes intrigue, investigations, leaks, intelligence, and threats keep the pace up.
Subgenre	Campaign / Election Drama	Covers the April 2023 announcement through Election Night 2024.
Subgenre	Alternate History	Real 2023 history, diverging from the moment Bullock enters the race.
Subgenre	Disaster / Crisis Drama	The catastrophic event and the national response that leads to more than two terms.
Subgenre	Character / Family Drama	The human cost: marriage, children, friendships, mental and physical toll.
Subgenre	Media Satire (light touch)	Headlines, cable chyrons, and social media show how the country reacts in real time.
Subgenre	Constitutional / Legal Drama	The 22nd Amendment and the legal battles over staying in office past two terms.

Recommended rating: TV-MA (film equivalent: **R**).

Real politics and the internet are profane, cruel, and graphic, and a catastrophic event needs to land with real weight. TV-MA lets the language, violence, and adult themes stay realistic instead of sanitized. It's the same tier as *House of Cards*, *Succession*, and *Veep*. Content descriptors: strong language, violence (crisis and security events), adult and sexual themes (implied, not gratuitous), substance references, and mature political themes.

4. Continuity System

- **Slug-line standard:** every scene opens with location plus a timestamp, e.g. *INT. KITCHEN — NIGHT — THURSDAY, APRIL 20, 2023 — 9:47 PM EDT*. Time zones are stated, and Daylight Saving Time is respected (2023 DST began March 12 and ended November 5).
- **Age formula:** Age = (scene year − birth year), minus 1 if the scene date falls before that year's birthday. Ages are shown in brackets the first time a character appears in each installment, e.g. JOE BIDEN (80).
- **Real-history rule:** before April 20, 2023, real events happen exactly as they did. After the announcement, real history stays the baseline, but anything Bullock's campaign or presidency would logically affect can diverge (butterfly effect). Every divergence is logged.
- **Canon Ledger:** a running PDF log of every date, quote, poll number, vote count, injury, hire, firing, death, and headline that can be called back later.
- **Document numbering:** each PDF is numbered in sequence (Bible docs 01, 02...; story installments numbered by Book and Chapter) so the order is never ambiguous.

5. Real-World 2023 Timeline Anchors (Jan 1 – Apr 25)

Date (2023)	Real event (canon unless Bullock alters it after Apr 20)
Sun Jan 1	New Year's Day. The story begins.
Tue Jan 3 – Sat Jan 7	118th Congress convenes. House Speaker fight runs 15 ballots; Kevin McCarthy is elected around 12:40 AM on Jan 7.
Jan 9 – Jan 12	Biden classified documents story breaks; on Jan 12, AG Garland appoints Special Counsel Robert Hur.
Thu Jan 19	The U.S. hits the debt ceiling; Treasury begins extraordinary measures.
Feb 1 – Sat Feb 4	Chinese surveillance balloon crosses the U.S.; shot down off South Carolina on Feb 4.
Fri Feb 3	Norfolk Southern derailment in East Palestine, Ohio.
Tue Feb 7	Biden's State of the Union.
Tue Feb 14	Nikki Haley announces for President.
Tue Feb 21	Vivek Ramaswamy announces for President.
Sat Mar 4	Marianne Williamson formally launches her Democratic campaign.
Fri Mar 10	Silicon Valley Bank collapses.
Thu Mar 30	Donald Trump indicted by a Manhattan grand jury.
Tue Apr 4	Trump arraigned in Manhattan on 34 felony counts.
Tue Apr 18	Fox News settles with Dominion for $787.5 million.
Wed Apr 19	Robert F. Kennedy Jr. announces his Democratic campaign in Boston.

Date (2023)	Real event (canon unless Bullock alters it after Apr 20)
Thu Apr 20	**MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK ANNOUNCES — UNEXPECTED, SPUR OF THE MOMENT.** Same day: SpaceX's first Starship launch explodes over the Gulf (about 8:33 AM CDT). The date "4/20" will be fodder for internet jokes.
Mon Apr 24	Tucker Carlson out at Fox News; Don Lemon out at CNN.
Tue Apr 25	Biden's planned reelection announcement video (which could be reshaped by Bullock's entry five days earlier).

Real-Person Age Reference

Person	Birthday	Age Jan 1, 2023	Age Apr 20, 2023
Joe Biden	Nov 20, 1942	80	80
Donald Trump	Jun 14, 1946	76	76
Kamala Harris	Oct 20, 1964	58	58
Ron DeSantis	Sep 14, 1978	44	44
Nikki Haley	Jan 20, 1972	50	51
Vivek Ramaswamy	Aug 9, 1985	37	37
Robert F. Kennedy Jr.	Jan 17, 1954	68	69
Mike Pence	Jun 7, 1959	63	63
Chris Christie	Sep 6, 1962	60	60
Tim Scott	Sep 19, 1965	57	57
Marianne Williamson	Jul 8, 1952	70	70
Gavin Newsom	Oct 10, 1967	55	55
Kevin McCarthy	Jan 26, 1965	57	58
Hakeem Jeffries	Aug 4, 1970	52	52
Chuck Schumer	Nov 23, 1950	72	72
Mitch McConnell	Feb 20, 1942	80	81
Nancy Pelosi	Mar 26, 1940	82	83
Marc-Anthony Bullock	**Jan 5, 1992**	30	31 (33 at inauguration; see 28th Amendment)

6. The "Nobody Is Nerfed" Principle

- Opponents are written at full strength. Trump keeps his base and his instincts, DeSantis his machine and his money, Biden his institutional experience, Harris her prosecutorial edge, Haley her discipline, and Ramaswamy his debate speed.
- The press is sharp. Reporters find real stories, ask hard questions, and remember everything.
- Institutions push back. Congress, the courts, the Senate parliamentarian, governors, the Pentagon, and the intelligence community act in character and in their own interests.
- Foreign leaders (Xi, Putin, Zelenskyy, Netanyahu, Modi, Macron, and others) are shrewd and play long games.

- Bullock wins because he outplays capable people, not because they suddenly get dumb. His mistakes cost him real things.
- His allies and staff are capable too, and capable people disagree, quit, leak, and sometimes betray.

7. Key Constitutional Continuity Notes

- **Term dates:** Inauguration as 47th President on Monday, January 20, 2025 at noon ET. Term 1 ends January 20, 2029. Term 2 ends January 20, 2033. Any third term would begin January 20, 2033.
- **The 22nd Amendment** bars election to the Presidency more than twice. Serving beyond two terms needs an on-page mechanism, such as repeal or amendment (two-thirds of both chambers plus 38 states), a Supreme Court fight, or an emergency succession scenario. The catastrophic event has to plausibly drive that change, and the opposition fights it at full strength.
- **Eligibility:** natural-born citizen and 14 years a U.S. resident. The age minimum was 35 until the **28th Amendment** (ratified Dec 17, 2024 in our timeline) lowered it to 25 (see Bible 03 and 05).
- **Real-world divergence:** in our story Bullock, not Donald Trump, becomes the 47th President. The 2024 election results diverge from real life.

8. Open Items Needed from the Author

- Marc-Anthony Bullock's birthplace and hometown in 2023 (birthday locked: Jan 5, 1992).
- His **party**: Democrat, Republican, Independent, or a new party (this decides which primary he enters, or whether he skips primaries).
- His background in 2023: profession, public profile, wealth, education, and any political or military history.
- Family: spouse or partner, children, parents, siblings, with birthdays.
- The circumstances of the spur-of-the-moment announcement: where, in front of whom, and what triggers it.
- The nature and date of the catastrophic event.
- The fictional cast (author to create).